

1421–22



Filippo Maria Visconti of Milan sits in state; having assassinated his brother to become duke of Milan, he restored Visconti hegemony over northern Italy.

SULTAN MEHMED I

(1382–1421) had successfully **restored the Ottoman state** after the Timurid invasion (see 1401–03), although his navy had come out worse in a conflict with the **Venetians** at the **Battle of Gallipoli** in 1416, forcing the Ottomans to recognize Venetian claims in Albania. In 1421, Mehmed died and his son, **Murad II** (1404–51), became sultan. Domestically, he restored the *devshirme* practice of training Christian slaves for key roles in government; externally, he pursued a policy of renewed expansion, beginning with the first **Ottoman siege of Constantinople**. The siege was unsuccessful and Mehmed was distracted by an uprising led by the Sufi theologian and preacher Sheikh Bedreddin—it was suppressed, and the sheikh was executed.

The **Visconti family** had ruled **Milan** since Archbishop Otto Visconti rose to power in 1277; their domain had spread to encompass much of northern Italy, reaching its height under **Gian Galeazzo** (1351–1402), sole ruler from 1385. He had made marriage alliances with the chief monarchs of Europe; was made hereditary duke in 1395; mastered Verona, Vicenza, Padua, Pisa, Siena, Assisi, and Perugia



Sultan Murad II

Murad defended and extended the Ottoman Empire, and was also a patron of poetry and learning, making his court a cultural center.

between 1386 and 1400; and threatened Florence until his death in 1402. Strife between his sons Gian Maria and Filippo Maria saw this empire disintegrate, but when Filippo had Gian assassinated in 1412, he set about restoring it, **regaining Genoa** in 1421. The Visconti patronized the arts and scholarship, helping to drive the **Renaissance** (see pp. 208–09). The French had suffered great losses at **Agincourt** (see 1411–15), and in 1420, at the prompting of the pro-English **Burgundians**, Charles VI of France had accepted the **Treaty of Troyes** and acknowledged Henry V of England as his heir and immediate regent. The agreement ceded all the conquered lands up to the Loire to the English and declared the dauphin, Charles, to be illegitimate. The **English** now **controlled northern France**. In 1422, both Henry and Charles died, and under the terms of the Treaty, the infant Henry VI was acclaimed king of both England and France. The dauphin, based at Bourges, refused to accept this, and the **Hundred Years' War** (see 1411–15) continued.

1423–25



The Doge's Palace, seat of the doge of Venice, is a masterpiece of 14th-century Gothic architecture, overlain with 15th, 16th, and 17th century additions.

IN THE 1420S, THE CULTURAL

MOVEMENT known later as the Italian or **High Renaissance** gathered pace, particularly in the field of **painting and the visual arts**. In 1424, the sculptor Lorenzo Ghiberti (1378–1455) completed the gilded bronze doors for the **Florence Baptistry** that he had been commissioned to make in 1403; the following year he was commissioned for a further set. Working at the same time as Ghiberti were a host of other artists, including Brunelleschi, Jacopo della Quercia, Masaccio, Donatello, Gentile da Fabriano, Jan van Eyck, and many more.

The Tribute Money

Tommaso di Ser Giovanni di Simone Masaccio died at just 27 years old, but created some of the most influential artworks of the Renaissance.

Although **Florence** was the heart of the Renaissance in the 15th century, the other great Italian power centers of Milan, Rome, and Venice also fostered artistic and architectural achievement. In Venice, the **Doge's Palace**, which had been evolving since its origins in the 9th century, embodied many of the architectural high points of the previous six centuries. The current building began to take shape around 1340; work on the side overlooking the Piazzetta did not begin until 1424, under Doge Francesco Foscari (1373–1457).

In 1424, Timur's descendant, Ulugh Beg (1394–1449)—astronomer and future Mongol leader—built a great **observatory** in Samarkand. It was equipped with a 130-ft (40-m) sextant, and Ulugh and his team of scholars cataloged over a thousand stars.

1426–30



Joan of Arc leads troops into battle, wielding a crossbow.



Bodkin point

This type of arrowhead is an uncomplicated, squared, metal spike, extensively used during the wars of the Middle Ages.

THE DAUGHTER OF A FARMER,

JOAN OF ARC (1412–31) was 16 when in 1429 voices in her head commanded her to bear aid to the French dauphin (see 1421–22). The English under John, duke of Bedford (1389–1435), had made further gains against the forces of



- 1421 Milan annexes Genoa; defeats Swiss
- 1421 Czech estates form autonomous government; repel second anti-Hussite crusade
- October 21, 1422 Death of Charles VI of France (b. 1368)
- August 31, 1422 Death of Henry V of England in France; succession of Henry VI (b. 1387)
- 1422 Chinese explorer Zheng He's 6th voyage brings giraffes back from Africa
- 1422 First Ottoman siege of Constantinople

- August 17, 1424 Duke of Bedford, regent of France, defeats supporters of dauphin Charles at Battle of Verneuil
- 1424 Francesco Sforza succeeds his father as condottiero (leader) of a mercenary company, Milan
- 1424 Italian artist Lorenzo Ghiberti completes doors to Florence Baptistry
- 1424 Ulugh Beg (1394–1449), ruler of Samarkand, builds observatory
- 1424 Ottomans take Smyrna, Anatolia
- 1424 Renovation begins on Piazzetta facade of Doge's Palace, Venice
- 1426 Hussites under Procopius the Great (c. 1380–1434) defeat third anti-Hussite crusade
- 1427 Venetian forces take Bergamo from Milan, northern Italy
- 1427 Portuguese discover the Azores, North Atlantic
- 1428 Le dynasty in Vietnam wins independence from China
- May 1429 Joan of Arc relieves siege of Orleans